भारतीय प्रबंध संस्थान बेंगलूर
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT
BANGALORE

Spiritual Book Distribution to Stressful Working Professionals

Venturing on a Budget: Rs 250

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1. Executive Summary

This report documents my micro-venture undertaken under the strict ₹250 constraint as part of the course Venturing on a Budget: Rs 250. My idea was to distribute small spiritual books to working professionals who appear stressed and constantly engaged in the rat race of material success.

Instead of choosing a large religious text like the Bhagavad Gita, I selected smaller books written by A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, which are easier for beginners to read and more affordable within the given budget. With an investment of ₹240, I purchased 8 books (3 English and 5 Hindi) and operated for 30 minutes at Huda City Centre Metro Station in Gurugram during peak evening office hours.

I adopted a voluntary contribution model where I informed people about the cost of the book and allowed them to contribute whatever they felt appropriate. During execution, 2 books were distributed, generating ₹181 in revenue, resulting in a financial loss of ₹59. Although financially negative, the venture generated significant learning in persuasion, confidence-building, and understanding public receptivity toward spirituality

2. Introduction and Opportunity Identification

My idea was to distribute spiritual books to working professionals who are stressed and seeking happiness. I believe spirituality is one of the most effective ways to attain long-term peace and clarity, and knowledge through books is an accessible entry point.

Although the Bhagavad Gita is the best spiritual text, its size may create hesitation for beginners. Therefore, I selected smaller books by A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, which are easily readable yet provide deep insights into spirituality.

Considering the ₹250 budget constraint, purchasing smaller books allowed me to reach more individuals rather than investing in only one or two larger books. The opportunity

was identified by observing office professionals returning from work in the evening at Huda City Centre Metro Station, who often appear tired and mentally occupied.

3. Venture Objective and Value Proposition

In today's world, it appears that many people are not satisfied despite material success. For example, on February 5, 2026, Elon Musk posted on X, "Whoever said 'money can't buy happiness' really knew what they were talking about." This reflects a broader misconception that financial success alone guarantees happiness.

People work continuously to earn more, yet desires keep increasing. This pattern creates stress, especially among youth engaged in corporate jobs. Many do not reflect on the deeper purpose of life.

The objective of this venture was to introduce spirituality as a possible source of inner satisfaction and meaning. I wanted to help at least a few individuals step out of the constant pursuit of material success and explore reflective thought.

Spirituality, in my understanding, is a way to know the Supreme power that created and sustains the world. Through knowledge and reflection, individuals may find clarity, purpose, and peace.

Value Proposition

- *Affordable spiritual literature (₹30 per book)*
- *Beginner-friendly format*
- *Voluntary donation model (no price pressure)*
- *Accessible at a high-footfall public location*
- *Immediate and non-committal introduction to spirituality*

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4. Execution Strategy (30-Minute Plan)

I visited the ISKCON temple and carefully selected the most suitable beginner-friendly book after reviewing several options. My selection criteria were readability, depth of content, and affordability.

I chose Huda City Centre Metro Station in Gurugram because of high evening footfall of working professionals around 6 PM, when stress levels after work are likely to be high.

I planned to wear traditional dhoti-kurta and apply ISKCON tilak to represent authenticity and align my appearance with the product being offered.

For pricing, I decided to clearly state the cost of the book and allow individuals to contribute whatever they felt appropriate. This voluntary contribution model reduced transaction pressure and created openness in interaction.

5. Financial Details

Investment: ₹240 Cost per Unit: ₹30 Quantity Purchased: 8	Revenue Generated: ₹181 (2 books distributed) Net Outcome: ₹59 Loss

6. Results and Outcome

Initially, I was unable to speak confidently. I was shivering and hesitant while approaching people. However, after approximately 10–15 minutes, the first individual stopped and inquired about the book. He was very kind and after I explained the book, he contributed ₹151.

This interaction significantly increased my confidence. After around 20 minutes, I was approaching people more confidently, although most ignored the offer. Two to three others stopped but I was unable to convince them.

The second book was distributed for ₹30 to a person of my age who was inquisitive about spirituality.

Although only 2 books were distributed, two meaningful conversations were initiated

7. Key Challenges and Learnings

The biggest challenge for me was internal fear. I am not naturally comfortable with public interaction, and when speaking to strangers I sometimes shiver and lose clarity.

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This experience was similar to bungee jumping — initially extremely nervous, but gradually becoming confident after repeated attempts.

Another challenge was the perception among youth that spirituality is relevant only for older individuals, not for young professionals.

Learnings:

- *Persuasion is difficult even for low-priced products.*
- *Assumption that ₹30 is "easy to sell" was incorrect.*
- *Emotional products require higher trust.*
- *Rejection is common in real-world selling.*
- *Confidence improves only through action*

8. Business Model: Activities, Transactions

Investment: *₹240 allocated for procurement of 8 beginner-friendly spiritual books.*

Vendor-Side Activities: *Visiting ISKCON, evaluating book options, purchasing inventory.*

Customer-Side Activities: *Location selection (Huda City Centre Metro), appearance positioning (dhoti-kurta & tilak), approaching working professionals, initiating spiritual conversation.*

Vendor Transactions: *Purchase of 8 books at ₹30 per unit from ISKCON.*

Customer Transaction Attempts: *Multiple professionals approached during 30-minute execution window.*

Successful Customer Transactions: *2 books distributed in exchange for voluntary contributions (₹151 and ₹30).*

Uncertainty: *Unknown receptivity of stressed professionals toward spirituality and unpredictable donation amount.*

Value Delivery Mechanism: *Emotional persuasion and reflective dialogue rather than functional utility selling.*

Revenue Realization: *₹181 cash inflow from voluntary contributions.*

Profit Calculation: *Total Revenue (₹181) – Total Investment (₹240) = ₹59 loss.*

9. Creative Framework Application

In this section explain:

SCAMPER

- *Substitute → Small book instead of Gita*
- *Modify → Donation-based model*
- *Eliminate → Removed fixed pricing pressure.*

Challenging Assumptions

Assumption: People only buy for utility
I tested: People may buy for meaning.

Lateral Thinking

Selling spirituality books in a metro station (unexpected space)

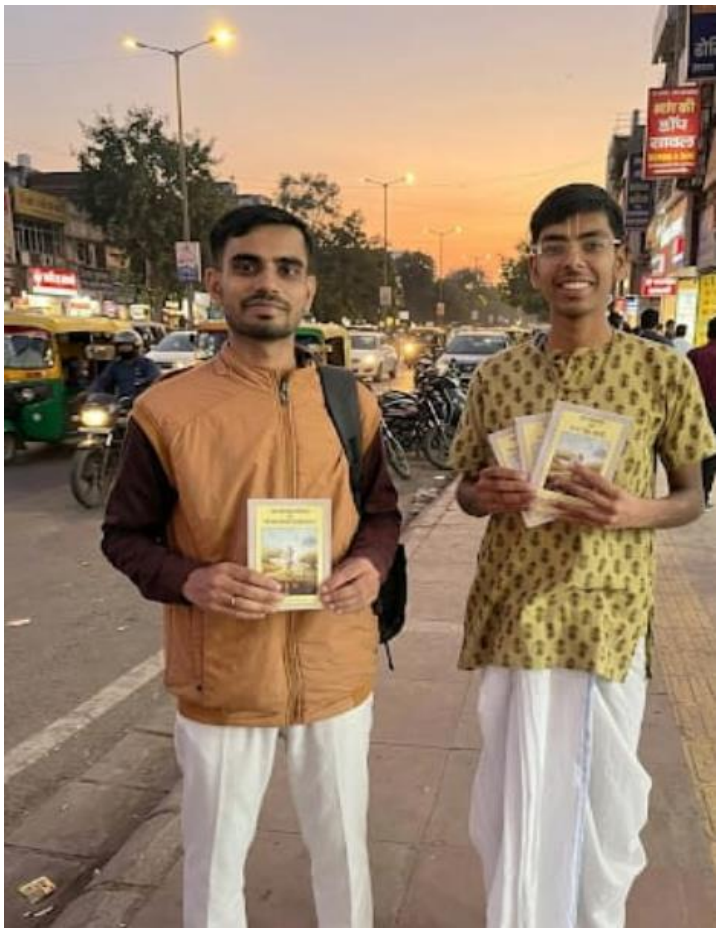
10. Conclusion

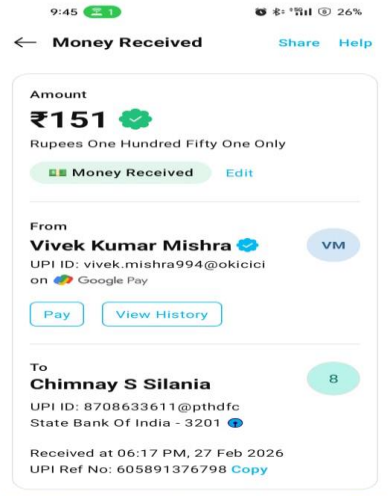
This venture demonstrated that entrepreneurship is not only about profit but about execution under uncertainty. While the financial outcome was negative, the psychological and experiential gains were significant.

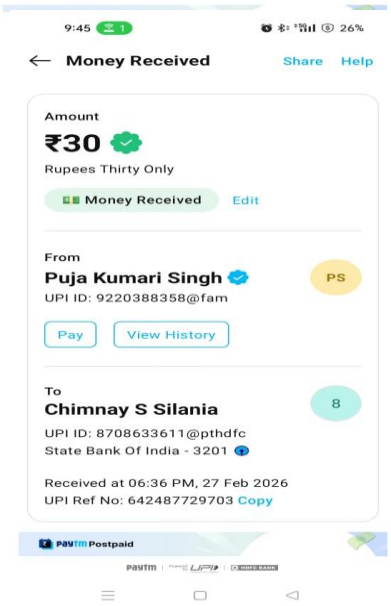
The activity pushed me beyond my comfort zone and allowed me to confront fear, rejection, and hesitation directly. It provided real-world exposure to customer behavior, persuasion difficulty, and market unpredictability. More importantly, it helped me

understand that meaningful ventures may not always yield immediate financial returns but can generate long-term personal growth.

11. Appendix (Evidence)







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